
HS 539: Post-War Germany: Politics, Society, and Culture

Course Code	HS 539
Course Name	Post-War Germany: Politics, Society, and Culture
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	Ph.D./Masters/B.Tech. (3rd and 4th year)
Distribution	HSS Free Elective
Approval	31st BoA (Sep 2019); 23rd Senate (Oct 2019)

Course Contents

- **Module I** [2 Lectures]
 - This module provides the students with a background on the events leading up to the Second World War, briefly outlining topics like the First World War, Weimar Republic, and National Socialism among others.
- **Module II: Allied Occupation of Germany** [4 Lectures]
 - Zero hour/Stunde Null
 - Denazification
 - Four occupation zones
- **Module III: Germany-US relations** [2 Lectures]
 - Bizone/Trizone
 - Berlin Blockade
 - European Recovery Program/Marshall Plan
- **Module IV: GDR and FRG** [12 Lectures]
 - Formation of GDR and FRG
 - Comparison of political and economic systems. Basic Law
 - Democratisation of education
 - NATO and Warsaw Pact
 - Adenauer era
 - Brandts Ostpolitik
- **Module V: Anti Government Protests** [2 Lectures]
 - East German uprising
 - Students movement
 - Green movement (anti-nuclear movement, environmentalism)
- **Module VI: Migrants in Germany** [4 Lectures]
 - Gastarbeiter/Guest Worker
 - Debate over Multiculturalism
 - Current migrant crisis
 - Emergence of far-right parties like AfD
- **Module VII: The reunification of Germany** [2 Lectures]
 - Fall of the Berlin Wall
 - Reunification
 - Problems in the process of internal integration
- **Module VIII: Post-War German Cinema/Literature** [6 Lectures]

- The students will engage with selected works of German literature/cinema, which will offer them a historical as well as a cultural perspective of the German society as it existed during the postwar period. It will include dealing with themes like Heimat (homeland), Vergangenheitsbewältigung (coming to terms with the past), and Wende (turn).
- **Module IX: European Union as it exists today** [8 Lectures]
 - European Integration (ECSC, EEC)
 - Expansion of the EU (1993 today)
 - Germany's role within the EU
 - Euroscepticism
 - Brexit

Text Books

1. Judt, Tony, **Postwar: A History of Europe since 1945**, Penguin Press, 2005.
2. Staab, Andreas, **The European Union Explained: Institutions, Actors, Global Impact, Bloomington**, Indiana University Press, 2008.

References

1. Braunthal, G, Right-Wing Extremism in Contemporary Germany, Palgrave Macmillan UK, 2009
2. Childs, David, The Fall of the GDR: Germany's Road To Unity, Longman, 2001
3. Dennis, Mike, The Rise and Fall of the German Democratic Republic 1945-1990, London: Routledge, 2000
4. Dinan, Desmond: Europe Recast: A History of European Union, Boulder, Lynne Rienner Publishers, 2014
5. Fulbrook, Mary, A History of Germany 1918-2014: The Divided Nation, Wiley- Blackwell 2014
6. Gilbert, Mark: European Integration: A concise History, Rowman & Littlefield, 2012
7. Gktrk, Deniz, David Gramling and Anton Kaes (eds.), Germany in Transit: Nation and Migration, 1955-2005, California: University of California Press, 2007
8. Hofmann, Arne, The Emergence of D'tente in Europe: Brandt, Kennedy and the Formation of Ostpolitik, London, New York: Routledge: 2007.
9. Jones, Erik, Anand Menon and Stephen Weatherill (eds.): The Oxford Handbook of the European Union, Oxford, Oxford University Press, 2012
10. Kitchen, Martin: A History of Modern Germany 1800-2000, Malden, Blackwell, 2006
11. Maier, C.S. and G. Bischof (eds.) The Marshall Plan and Germany: West German Development within the Framework of the European Recovery Programme, Oxford: Berg, 1991.
12. McCormick, John: Understanding the European Union, New York, Palgrave, 2008
13. Miller, Jan-Werner (ed.): German ideologies since 1945; studies in the political thought and culture of the Bonn republic, New York 2003
14. Pulzer, Peter: German Politics 1945-1995, New York, Oxford University Press, 1996
15. Smith, Helmut Walser (ed.): The Oxford Handbook of Modern German History, Oxford, 2011
16. Vorlnder, Hans, Maik Herold, Steven Schiller, PEGIDA and New Right-Wing Populism in Germany, Palgrave Macmillan, 2018.
17. Warleigh-Lack, Alex: European Union: The Basics, London, Routledge, 2008
18. Wilhelm, Cornelia (ed), Migration, Memory and Diversity: From 1945 to the Present, New York: Berghahn Books, 2016.